

## SPORTING RIFLES

**Sporting rifles were made** in fascinating varieties, influenced by many factors. These included popular regional styles, new technologies, and the size and nature of the game the rifle was used to hunt—from birds and rabbits to deer and elephants. The taste and budget of the owner also affected the design of these rifles. Sporting rifles were often more technically sophisticated than contemporary military arms, since they were not going to be subjected to a harsh environment or extended use on the battlefield.

### ▼ PERCUSSION UNDER-HAMMER RIFLE

**Date** 1835

**Origin** US

**Barrel** 29½in (75cm)

**Caliber** .44in

This under-hammer rifle by Vermont gunmaker Nicanor Kendall was a percussion-cap muzzle-loader. Its stock is probably of American Cherry and the furniture (gun parts such as trigger guard and butt plate) is of a high nickel-copper alloy which is cast and incised with decoration. The heavy octagonal barrel is fitted with four ramrod pipes, a leaf rear sight, and a blade foresight.

### ▲ COLT PATERSON REVOLVING RIFLE

**Date** 1837

**Origin** US

**Barrel** 32in (81.3cm)

**Caliber** .36in

Samuel Colt's first factory in Paterson, New Jersey, produced revolving rifles as well as pistols. However, it had limited facilities and went bankrupt. Paterson-built Colt rifles, such as this first-pattern concealed-hammer eight-shot rifle, are extremely rare. This muzzle-loading revolving rifle used percussion caps.

